

UNIT 8: DAILY LIFE ON THE VIETNAM COAST GUARD SHIP: CHALLENGES AND REWARDS

I. INTRODUCTION

The Vietnam Coast Guard often has to perform long-term patrol missions at sea. Despite having to work in difficult living conditions, far from their families, officers and soldiers on the Vietnam Coast Guard ship were still determined to successfully complete their assigned tasks. The lesson will introduce the daily life of the crew members on the Vietnam Coast Guard ship while performing their patrol, inspection and control duties.

II. TEXT

The Vietnam Coast Guard is a branch of the military that performs both civil and military missions. Coast Guard officers and crew members are often stationed on ships that patrol the nation's waters and respond to emergencies. But what is daily life like on a coast guard ship? How do they balance their professional and personal lives? What are some of the challenges and rewards of serving at sea?

Daily life on a the Vietnam Coast Guard ship can vary depending on the type, size, and mission of the vessel. Some ships are larger and have longer patrols, while others are smaller and have shorter patrols. Some ships are deployed for search and



rescue, law enforcement, environmental protection, while others are involved in training, research, or maintenance.

Maintenance of weapons on board - Photo:Internet

However, some common aspects of daily life on the Vietnam Coast Guard ship include:

Routine and discipline. The Vietnam Coast Guard members follow a strict schedule of duty rotations, **watchstanding**, training, drills, inspections, and maintenance. They also have to **adhere** to rules and regulations regarding uniforms, conduct, and safety. They have to be ready for any situation that may arise at sea, such as storms, fires, collisions, or medical emergencies.

Teamwork and friendship.

Coast guard members work closely with their shipmates and form strong bonds of friendship and trust. They rely on each other for support, guidance, and assistance. They also have fun together by playing games, watching movies, celebrating holidays, or organizing events. They often develop a sense of pride and loyalty to their ship and their unit.

Challenges and hardships.

The Vietnam Coast Guard members face many challenges and hardships while serving at sea. They have to deal with long hours, physical demands, stressful situations, and constant changes. They also have to cope with separation from their families and friends, limited communication, isolation, boredom, and homesickness. They may encounter dangers such as hostile forces, pirates, smugglers, terrorists or extreme weather condition on sea.

The Vietnam Coast Guard participates in the rescue of foreign ships at sea

Photo: Internet

Rewards and opportunities.

The Vietnam Coast Guard members also enjoy many rewards and opportunities while serving at sea. They get to learn new skills and gain valuable experience. They get to help people in need and protect the environment. They get to make a difference and serve their country.

Daily life on the Vietnam Coast Guard ship is not easy, but it can be fulfilling and rewarding for those who choose this career path. The Vietnam Coast Guard members are proud of their service and their contribution to the nation's security and prosperity.

III. GRAMMAR

1. Verb patterns 1

1.1. Verb +to+ infinitive

E.g. They want to buy a new car.

I'd like to go abroad.

1.2. Verb + -ing

E.g. Everyone loves going to parties.

He finished reading his book.

1.3. Verb + -ing or + to + infinitive with no change in meaning

E.g. It began to rain/raining.

I continued to work/working in the library.

1.4. Verb + preposition + -ing

E.g. We're thinking of moving house.

I'm looking forward to having more free time.

1.5. Like doing and would like to do

a) *Like doing* and *love doing* express a general enjoyment.

E.g. I like working as a teacher = I'm a teacher and I enjoy it.

I love dancing = This is one of my hobbies.

b) *Would like to do* and *would love to do* express a preference now or at a specific time.

E.g. I'd like to be a teacher. = When I grow up, I want to be a teacher

Thank you. I'd love to dance. = We're at a disco. I'm pleased that you asked me.

c) *Questions and short answers*

E.g. Would you like to dance? - Yes, I would. / Yes, I'd love to.

Would you like to come for a walk? - Yes, I would. / No, thank you.

***Note:**

No, I wouldn't is not common because it is impolite.

2. Future intentions

2.1. Will

a) *Use*

Will is used:

- To express a future decision or intention made at the moment of speaking.

E.g. A: It's Jane's birthday.

B: Is it? I'll buy her some flowers.

- To express an offer.

E.g. I'll carry your suitcase.

We'll do the washing-up.

b) Form

- Positive

S + will + V_{bare inf}

Will is a modal auxiliary verb. The forms of *will* are the same for all persons.

E.g. She will go to Ho Chi Minh city.

- Negative

S+will+not+ V_{bare inf}

will not = won't

E.g. They will not buy that house.

He will not send this letter to him.

- Yes/No question

Will +S+V_{bare inf}?

Yes, S + will

No, S+ will + not

E.g. Will you help me?

Yes, I will. /No, I won't.

-Wh-question

Wh/How + will + S+ V_{bare inf}?

E.g. Where will you go tomorrow?

I will go to a wedding party.

***Note:**

"No, I won't" is not common because it is impolite. It means "*I don't want to help you.*"

A polite way of saying "no" here is "*I'm afraid I can't.*"

2.2. Going to

a) Use

Going to is used:

- To express a future decision, intention or plan made before the moment of speaking.

E.g. She is going to have a birthday party.

They are going to stay in Rome.

b) Form

- Positive

S + am/is/are + going + to + V_{bare inf}
--

E.g. They are going to buy a new house.

I am going to have an exam next week.

- Negative

S + am/is/are + not + going + to + V_{bare inf}
--

E.g. I am not going to work

She is not wearing that shirt.

- Yes/No question

**Am/ Is / Are + S + going + to + V_{inf}?
Yes, S + am/is/ are.
No, S + am/ is/are + not.**

E.g. Are you going to get married next year? Yes, I am.

- Wh-question

Wh + am/is/are + S + going + to + V_{inf}?

***Note:** The Present Continuous can be used in a similar way for a plan or an arrangement, particularly with the verbs *go* and *come*.

E.g. She's coming on Friday.

I'm going home early tonight.

- When we can see or feel now that something is certain to happen in the future

E.g. Look at these clouds. It's going to rain.

Watch out! That box is going to fall.

- Will or going to?

I'm going to make a chicken casserole for dinner.

(I decided this morning and bought everything for it).

What shall I cook for dinner? Er.... I know! I'll make chicken casserole (I decided at the moment of speaking).

IV. VOCABULARY

1	Stationed	/'steɪʃnd/	v	Thực thi nhiệm vụ
---	-----------	------------	---	-------------------

2	Watchstanding		n	Canh gác
3	Adhere	/əd'hiə/	v	Gắn kết
4	Cope	/kəʊp/	v	Đối mặt với
5	Hardship	/'hɑːdʃɪp/	n	Khó khăn
6	Prosperity	/prɒs'perəti/	n	Thịnh vượng
7	Homesickness	/'həʊmsɪknəs/	n	Nhớ nhà
8	Patrol	/pə'trəʊl/	v	Tuần tra

V. PRACTICE

Exercise 1. Complete the sentences with the correct form of “be going to”

- I _____ (to visit) my commander next weekend.
- They _____ (to have) a brief tomorrow.
- She _____ (to start) a new career next month.
- The troops _____ (to deploy) to the combat zone next week.
- The general _____ (to give) a briefing tomorrow.
- The soldiers _____ (to complete) their training next month.

Exercise 2. Rewrite the sentences using “will”

- I am going to eat lunch.
- He is going to cut the rope.

- They are going to deploy a mission.
- The helicopter is going to land.
- The sergeant is going to inspect the barracks.
- The platoon is going to go on patrol

Exercise 3. Choose the correct form of the verb to complete the sentences

- I _____ (am going to/will) study for my exam.
- She _____ (is going to/will) call her friend.
- We _____ (are going to/will) have dinner together.
- The mission _____ (is going to/will) be dangerous.
- The commander _____ (is going to/will) address the troops.
- We _____ (are going to/will) follow orders.

*** Write sentences using “be going to” or “will” to talk about your future plans:**

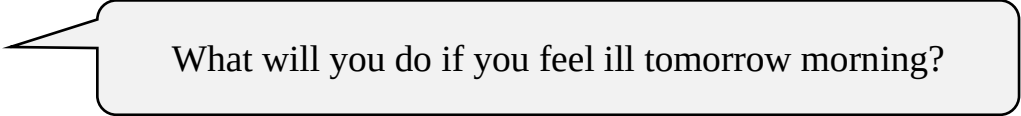
- Example: I am going to travel to Europe next year
- Example: The unit is going to conduct a training exercise next month.

Exercise 4. Complete the dialogue with the correct form of “be going to” or “will”

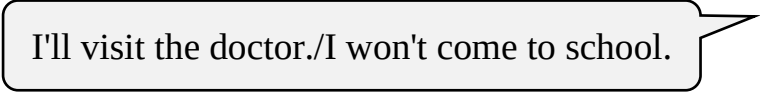
- A: What are you doing this weekend?
- B: I _____ (to visit) my family.
- A: That sounds nice. Have a good time!
- B: Thanks! I _____ (to bring) them some gifts.
- A: What are your orders, sir?
- B: We _____ (to attack) at dawn.
- A: Understood, sir. We _____ (to be) ready.

Exercise 5. Work in pairs. Ask and answer using the first conditional and the ideas below.

1. you feel ill tomorrow morning
2. the weather is fine at the weekend
3. there's a long power cut this evening
4. you get poor marks in your next English test
5. your best friend forgets your birthday
6. your own ideas



What will you do if you feel ill tomorrow morning?



I'll visit the doctor./I won't come to school.